Clément Montes

PhD candidate, CREST - Institut Polytechnique de Paris

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Nationality: French, Spanish
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Job Market

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Graduate coordinator: Alessandro Riboni alessandro.riboni@gmail.com

References

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Research interests

Geoeconomics, International Trade

Job Market Paper

Geoeconomic Coercion: Which Targets, Who Pays? (Link)

Abstract: This paper studies the incidence of economic sanctions, across countries and within each of them. I document that sanctions have increasingly targeted firms rather than entire sectors, a substitution unexplained by geopolitical factors. I develop a two-country model of sanctions with heterogeneous firms, international input sourcing and oligopolistic competition. Strategic interaction with unaffected rivals limits the ability of a targeted firm to pass the sanction cost on to consumers, forcing it to absorb much of the shock through lower profits. A sectoral embargo raises every firm's cost uniformly, making a larger share of the sanction reach consumers. In firm-level design, the profit loss relative to the loss in consumer surplus is maximized when targeting the largest firm in a sector. Simulations of the general equilibrium show that firm-level sanctions cost the target economy four times what they cost the sanctioning economy, against eleven under sectoral embargoes. A government maximizing damage inflicted per unit borne would therefore choose the sectoral design. Policymakers nonetheless use firm-level sanctions, revealing a preference over who within the target economy bears the cost.

Education

2022 - exp. June 2027	PhD Candidate in Economics, *CREST - Institut Polytechnique de Paris* Supervisor: Alessandro Riboni
Spring 2025	Visiting PhD student, *UC Berkeley (USA)* Host: Cecile Gaubert
Feb. 2024	Visiting PhD student, *Drexel University (USA)* Host: Yoto Yotov
2021	MSc in Economics with Honors, *Institut Polytechnique de Paris*
2021	Economics & Statistics engineer degree, *ENSAE Paris*

Academic activity

2026 - 2027 Teaching fellow (Demi ATER), *Sciences Po*

Work in progress

- **The Extraterritoriality of Smart Sanctions**

  Abstract: This paper presents the Firms Sanctioned DataBase (FSDB), a novel dataset documenting all firms and entities sanctioned by the European Union since 2001. The FSDB details the timeline of sanctions and the exact addresses of every targets inside of sanction programs (e.g., Iran, Russia). Using this granular dataset, I characterize the anticipation and location of targets, and study how they affect the identification of the impact of sanctions on disaggregated bilateral trade flows. I find that extraterritorial sanctions decreased flows of firms' sanctioned products by 38%. The estimate is similar when solely accounting for the staggered enforcement, with a higher variance though. Ignoring the staggered enforcement of sanctions considerably biases the estimate. Correcting for both biases, I find that the addition of a firm inside an already sanctioned sector additionally decreases trade flows by 17%.
- **The Determinants of the Success Rate of Firm-Level Sanctions**

Conferences and seminars

2026 CREST Macroeconomic seminar (Paris)*, Sciences Po (Paris), CREST PhD seminar, Silk Road Empirical Trade Conference (Astana), European Economic Association (Dublin), JIE summer school (Milan), International Conference on European Economics and Politics (Zurich), Workshop on European Defence and Defence Economics (Brno), GEP/CEPR Postgraduate Conference (Nottingham), Center for Inclusive Trade Policies (Brighton)

2025 UC Berkeley Trade Lunch Seminar, Western Economic Association International (San Francisco), European Association for Research in Industrial Economics (Valencia), European Trade Study Group - ETSG (Milan), CREST PhD seminar (Paris)

2024 Global Repercussions of International Economic Policies workshop (Istanbul), ETSG (Athens), LSE QueerConf (London), HEC (Paris), Drexel Sanction Workshop (Philadelphia), CREST PhD seminar (×2)

2023 CREST 1st year PhD students Workshop (Paris)

*: scheduled

Teaching

Graduate TA at Sciences Po

Fall 2026	International Trade for Thierry Mayer

Invited session for graduate students at Ecole Polytechnique

Dec. 2025, 2026*	International Economics, session on Geoeconomics for Gregory Corcos and David Guereiro

Graduate TA of Macroeconomics at ENSAE Paris

Spring 2024	Macroeconomics of fluctuation, for Franck Malherbet and Pablo Winant
Fall 2023 – 2025	Macroeconomics of growth, for Olivier Loisel

Graduate TA of Econometrics

Fall 2024	Econometrics, for Elia Lapenta (ENSAE Paris)
Fall 2023	Introduction to Time series, for Jean-Michel Zakoian (Ecole Polytechnique)
Spring 2023	Linear time series, for Christian Francq (ENSAE Paris)
2021 - 2022	Math+Econ+Code, for Alfred Galichon (Sciences Po Paris)

Undergraduate TA of Macroeconomics at ENSAE Paris

Fall 2025	Project in Descriptive Economics (on Economic Sanctions), Supervisor
Spring 2023, 2024	Introduction to macroeconomics, for Suzanne Bellue, Olivier Loisel and Franck Malherbet

*: scheduled

Refereeing

Open Economies Review

Grants and awards

2025 – 2026	4th-year PhD fellowship, *CIEDS*
2025	Mobility grant EUR
2022 – 2025	Full PhD scholarship, *DGRIS*

Professional service

2023 - now	Member of the CREST Listening Unit against sexism and harassment
2023 - 2024	Co-organizer of the CREST PhD Seminar
June 2022	Co-organizer of the CREST 1st year PhD students Workshop

Additional information

Languages
French – native
English – fluent
Spanish – conversational

Computer skills
Python, Matlab, Stata,
Julia, R, Git, LaTeX